

Consulting Services

One Platform. One Truth. Proven Compliance Support for Pipeline Operators.

The Paradigm Shift: From Prescriptive to Management Systems

The oil and gas pipeline regulatory landscape is undergoing a fundamental transformation, moving from legacy "check-the-box" prescriptive methodologies toward robust Management Systems. The industry benchmark is API RP 1173, the framework for Pipeline Safety Management Systems (PSMS), one of several standards integrated into the operator's IMS. This paradigm demands a migration from siloed, static documentation to a unified operational architecture where policies, procedures, and field execution are built into the organization's safety culture.

Systemic Compliance bridges the gap between fragmented silos and systemic outcomes. We resolve the Variability Paradox, the systemic failure where operators assume 100% of the legal and financial liability for contractor actions while possessing near-zero control over their qualifications or procedural adherence, transforming compliance from a manual, high-risk burden into a predictable, systemic result.

Comprehensive Consulting Service Offerings

Regulatory Program Development & Updates

- O&M Manual preparation and updates: aligning operational procedures with current regulatory mandates.
- MAOP reconfirmation and records validation: engineering-grade MAOP verification.
- CRM plan updates and fatigue mitigation: comprehensive Control Room Management strategies.
- DIMP implementation and risk-model updates: Distribution Integrity Management Program rewrites.
- IMP development and risk assessments: advanced Integrity Management Program architecture.
- Emergency Response and spill-response plan updates: critical preparedness documentation.
- Public Awareness (RP 1162) implementation and effectiveness evaluations.
- Annual reporting assistance: strategic support for PHMSA filings.

Audit Readiness & Representation

- PHMSA audit preparation and representation: strategic support during regulatory inspections.
- OQ program audits and updates; contractor OQ/PSMS alignment audits.
- Drug & Alcohol plan audits: PHMSA/DOT program compliance.
- Control Room Management (CRM) reviews: gap analysis and regulatory alignment.
- Mock regulatory inspections and remote records review.

PSMS Implementation & Technical Strategy

- API RP 1173 / PSMS gap assessments: roadmaps to management-system maturity.
- Management of Change (MOC) build-out: pre-job planning and change-detection processes.
- Records verification and data migration: strategic management of historical compliance data.

Field Operations & Emergency Preparedness

- Emergency drills and after-action reports: tabletop and full-scale exercises with evaluation.
- Leak surveys and emergency-plan development.
- Regulator and relief-valve inspections: technical calculations and inspection oversight.
- Damage prevention and 811 programs.
- Onsite field inspections of operations, procedures, and regulatory compliance.

Training & Competence

- Competence & Progression Framework and Competence Architect: role-based progression plans and training in four vehicles with exams, anchored to your own procedures (see the Training & Competence sheet).

The Value of Precision: Avoiding the Cost of Inaction

Regulatory non-compliance carries significant penalty, enforcement, and litigation exposure that far outweighs the investment in systemic management. SC reduces these risks at the source:

Risk Area	How a Systemic Approach Reduces It
OQ violation (wrong task list)	Procedures and task lists aligned 1:1 to the operator.
Evaluator lapse (invalidated qualifications)	Authorized, tracked evaluators and recordkeeping.
SWP violation (safety-framework conflict)	One standardized safe-work framework.
Post-MOC requalification gap	Change detection and requalification triggers.
COI lapse / litigation	Real-time tracking with automatic block.

Engagement Model & Subject-Matter Support

Support Tier	Description	Rate
SME Consultant	Strategic planning, audit representation, and technical program architecture.	\$225/hr
Clerical & Admin	Documentation maintenance, records management, and data entry.	\$50/hr

The Consulting Team: Unrivaled Industry Expertise

Comprised of former regulators and industry pioneers with decades of collective experience in PHMSA enforcement and industry leadership.

Kevin Graham *Founder, Systemic Compliance | 30+ years in pipeline compliance, OQ & management systems*

- Veriforce founder and original creator; Smith System / Pinion VP & GM, OQSG; Industrial Solutions Group VP of Compliance.
- ANSI/ASME B31Q Technical Committee member; API RP 1173 and API RP 1161 working groups; API-approved PSMS assessor.

Michael (Mike) Comstock *SME/Advisor | 40+ years in natural gas pipeline safety & utilities*

- EverLine, LLC Utilities Market Director; C&M Regulatory Pipeline Consultants Principal; City of Mesa energy-resources leadership.
- ANSI/ASME B31Q Technical Committee member; APGA Chairman; API-approved PSMS assessor.

Warren Miller *SME/Advisor | 50+ years in pipeline safety & regulatory compliance*

- PHMSA/DOT inspector, accident investigator, operations supervisor; co-developed national OQ inspection protocols.
- ANSI/ASME B31Q Technical Committee member; OQ Integrity Coalition founding member; API-approved PSMS assessor.

John Chin *SME/Advisor | 46+ years in design, construction, corrosion, OQ & integrity management*

- TransCanada/TC Energy Sr. Regulatory Compliance Specialist; El Paso Pipeline Group Principal Compliance Engineer and OQ committee chair.
- ANSI/ASME B31.8 Code Committee member; ANSI/ASME B31Q Technical Committee member; API-approved PSMS assessor.

Brad Heck *SME/Advisor | 40+ years in pipeline safety, OQ, PSMS & D/A programs*

- Miller Pipeline LLC Director of Corporate Compliance; OQ Integrity Process (OQIP) Coalition co-founder/chair.
- ANSI/ASME B31Q Technical Committee member; Midwest Energy Association Hall of Fame inductee; API-approved PSMS assessor.

Other Resources

We have access to extensive additional industry expertise and resources, allowing us to provide comprehensive, end-to-end support.



Ready to transform compliance from a liability into a systemic outcome?

Contact Systemic Compliance to schedule a consultation with our advisory team.

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